EXP 8

Configuring User Management and Role-Based Access Control (RBAC) in a Zoho Creator Application

Student Admission Enquiry

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AIM

To configure user management and role-based access control (RBAC) for the "Student Admission Enquiry Form" application in Zoho Creator, so that every category of user — Admission Manager, Admission Staff and portal-based applicants — is assigned an appropriately scoped role and permission profile, record visibility follows the reporting hierarchy, and the application interface is localized correctly for each user, without granting any user access beyond what their role requires.

1. PROCEDURE

1.1 Defining Roles and the Role Hierarchy

1. Open the application in Zoho Creator and go to Settings > Permissions > User Permissions > Roles tab. Select the "Admission Manager" role, set "Reports to" as CEO, and add the description "Manages student admission enquiries".

2. Set "Share Data with Peers" to Yes so that users placed under the same role can view each other's admission enquiry records. The users assigned to this role are listed under Associated Users.

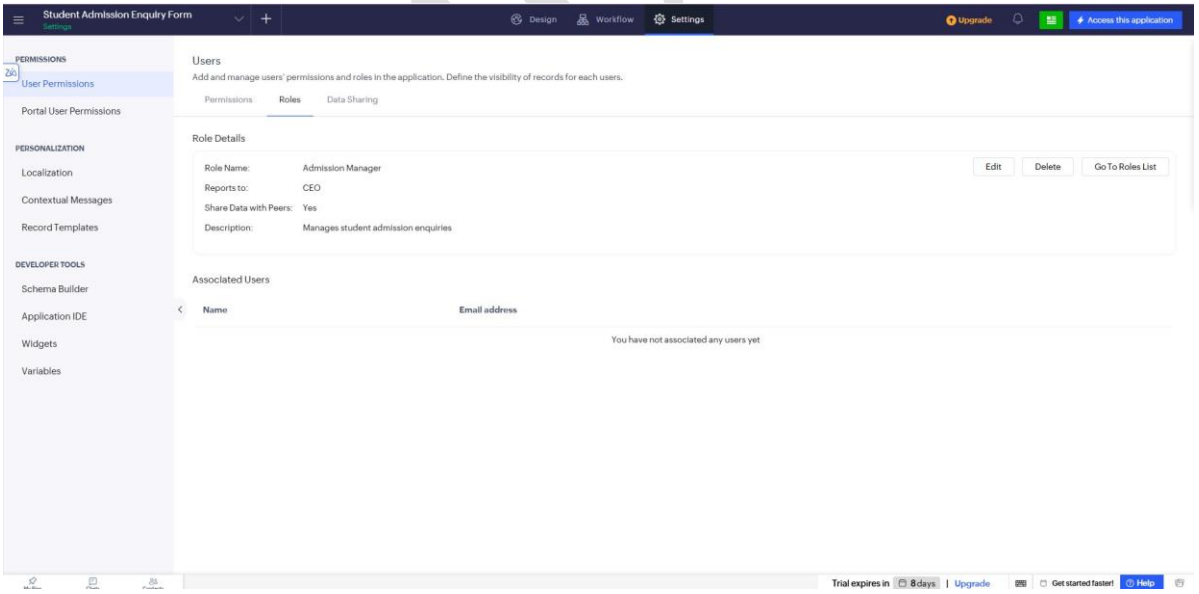


Fig 2.1: Roles tab — Admission Manager role configured with reporting hierarchy

Explanation: The "Reports to" field builds the reporting chain (Admission Manager to CEO) that Zoho Creator uses to decide which records a role can see above its own. "Share Data with Peers" extends visibility sideways to others holding the same role, so all Admission Managers can see and update the same enquiry records. Together these settings define the vertical and horizontal reach of the role's access, and the Associated Users table shows exactly who holds the role (currently no users are associated with it).

1.2 Creating Permission Profiles for Each User Category

2. Go to Settings > Permissions > User Permissions > Permissions tab and click "Add Permission" to create a separate permission profile for each category of user, each with its own descriptive name, alongside the built-in Write profile. Here the custom profile "rene" is created with read permission for all components.

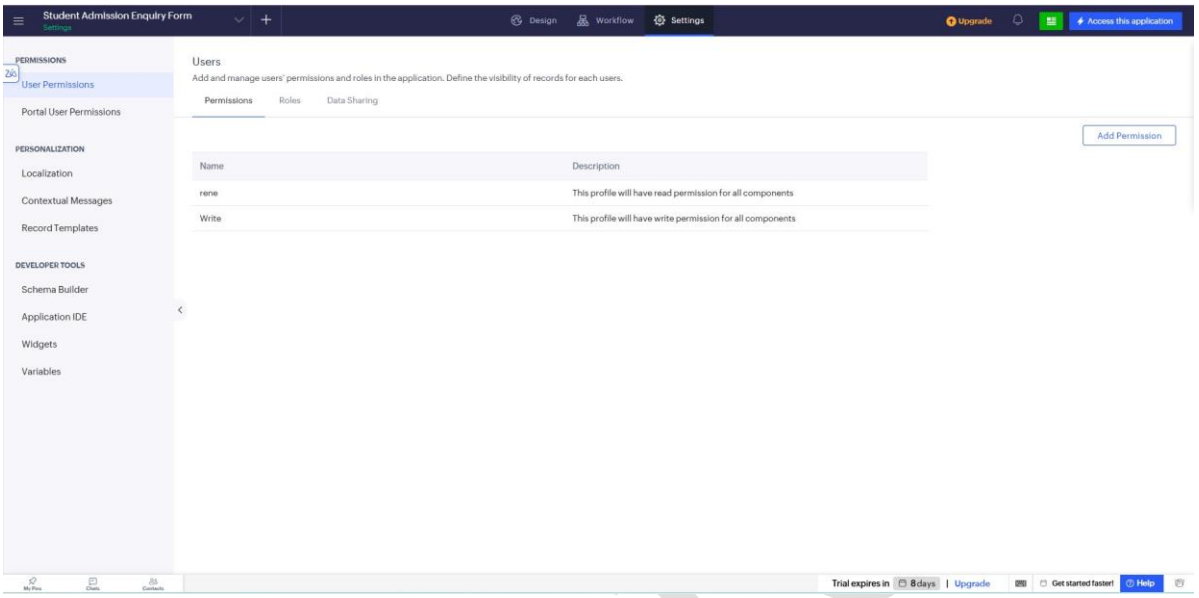


Fig 2.2: Permissions tab listing the permission profiles available in the application

Explanation: Each permission profile is an independently editable set of module-level and field-level access rights. The "rene" profile gives read-only access to all components, while the Write profile gives write access to all components. Using named profiles instead of one shared profile ensures each user can act only on the forms and reports relevant to their function, which is the core of role-based access control.

2.3 Setting Portal User Permissions

3. Go to the "Portal User Permissions" tab to manage access for portal users — applicants who interact with the application from outside the core organisation. Here the "Customer" profile is available as a portal-level permission.

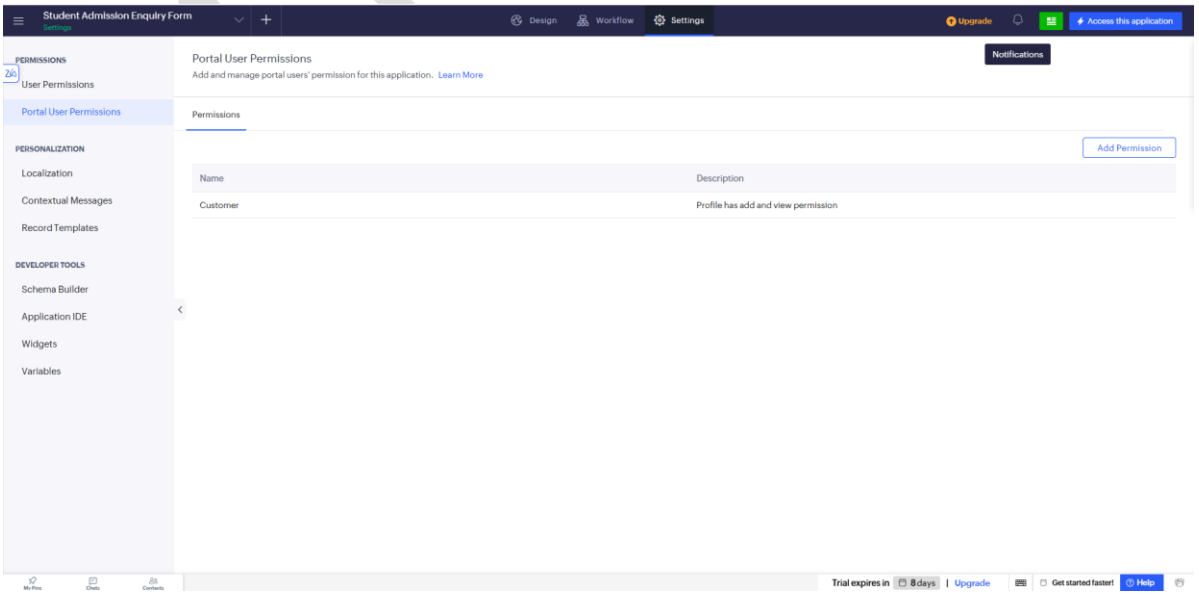


Fig 2.3: Portal User Permissions tab showing the profile available to portal users

Explanation: Portal users are kept separate from internal application users so that applicant-facing accounts can be given a restricted set of permissions without exposing internal roles or developer settings. The "Customer" profile has add and view permission only, which lets an applicant submit a student admission enquiry and view it, but not change or delete other records.

2.4 Configuring Application Localization

4. Go to Settings > Personalization > Localization and choose which language the application should use. "User's browser language" is selected, with English kept as the default language.

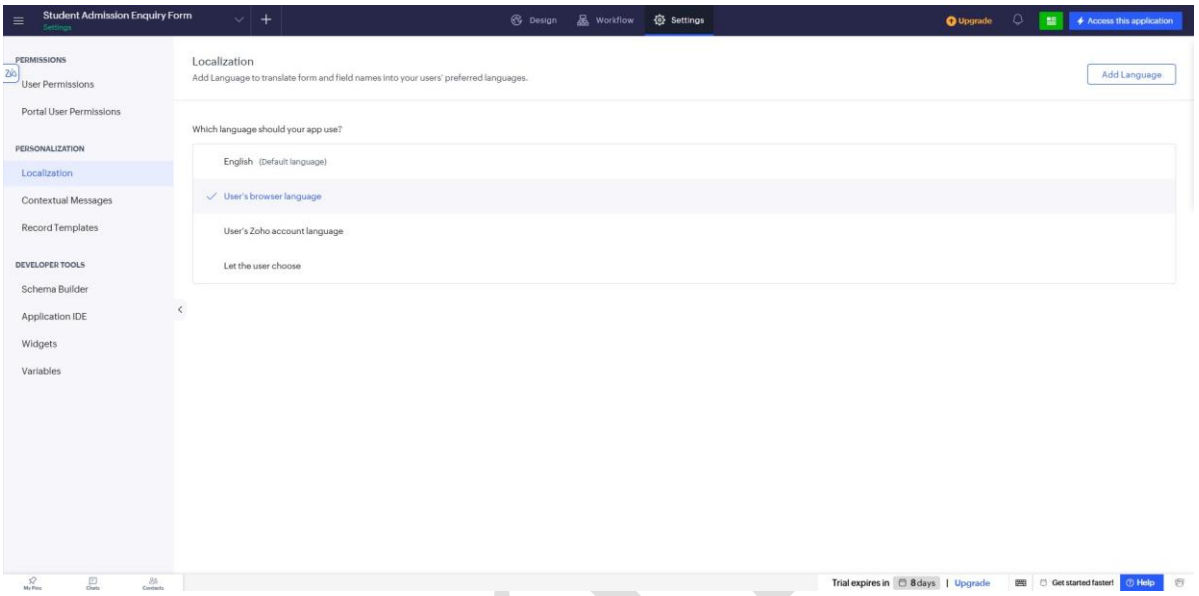


Fig 2.4: Localization settings for the application

Explanation: Localization works alongside RBAC to make the application usable for every user. Once a user's permission profile decides what they can access, the localization setting decides the language in which form and field names are displayed — based on their browser, their Zoho account language, or a language they choose themselves.

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2.5 Verifying Workflow Automations Under the Configured Roles

5. Go to the Workflow tab > Form workflows and confirm that the workflow built for the "Student Admission" form remains Enabled — the "Notify the student" workflow that runs on successful form submission (3 actions).

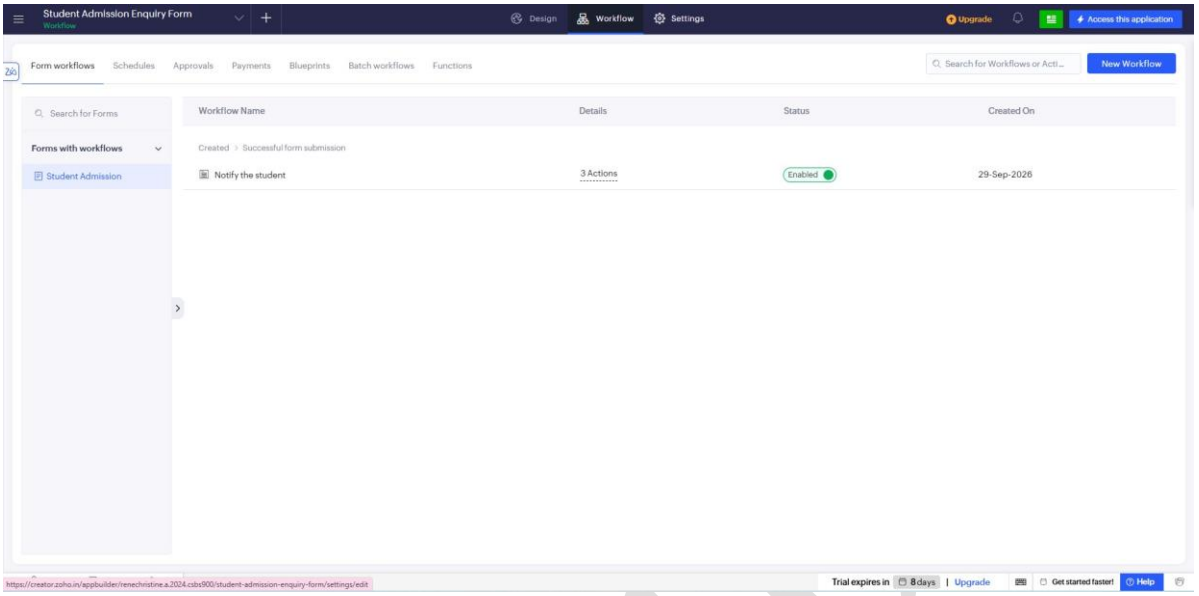


Fig 2.5: Form workflows list showing the Notify the student workflow still enabled

Explanation: The "Notify the student" workflow runs when a record is created and the form is successfully submitted. It fires regardless of which authorised role submits the enquiry form. Because this automation sits beneath the permission and role layer, it continues to execute consistently, confirming that RBAC and workflow automation operate together without conflict.

2.6 Adding a User and Assigning a Role and Permission

6. Open the Zoho Creator home page and go to Users > Add User. Enter the user's email address and name, keep "Send Notification Mail" ticked, and under Add to Application > Applications as User select the "Student Admission Enquiry Form" application, set the Role to "Admission Staff" and the Permission to "rene", then click Add User.

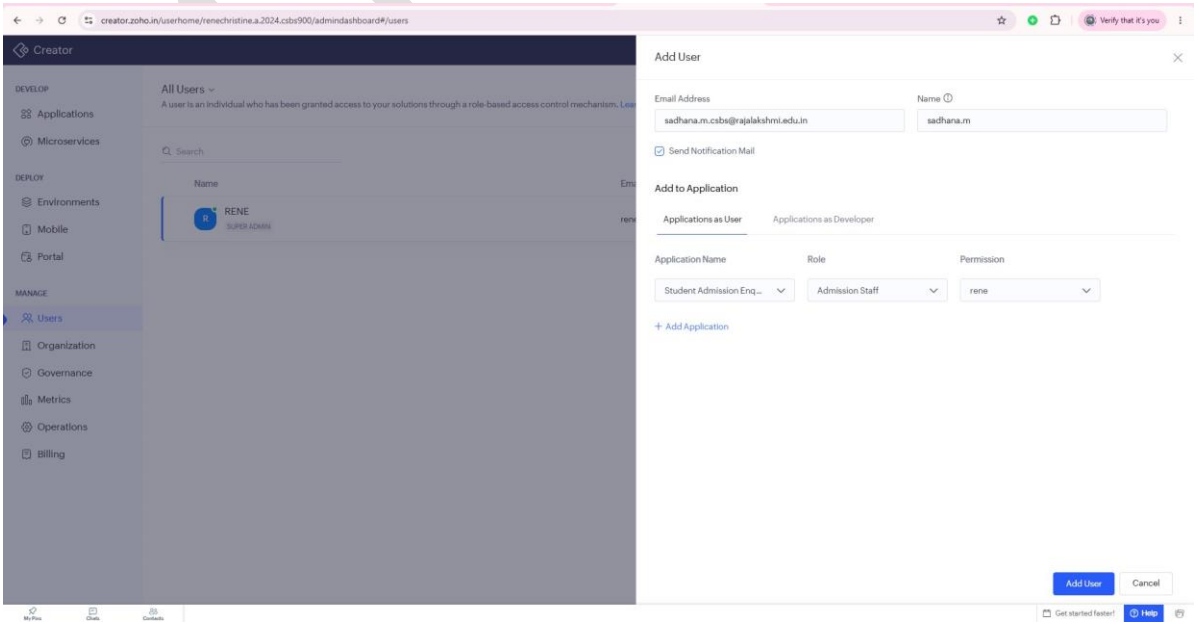


Fig 2.6: Add User dialog — user added to the application with the Admission Staff role and rene permission

Explanation: Creating the user is what ties the role and permission profiles defined earlier to a real person. Selecting the Admission Staff role places the user in the reporting hierarchy, and the "rene" permission (read access) decides which components the user can view, so the user receives only the access that role requires. The notification mail invites the user to access the application.

3. OUTPUT

Once the roles, permission profiles, portal permissions and localization settings were saved and the user was added, the All Users page listed the users who now have access to the application.

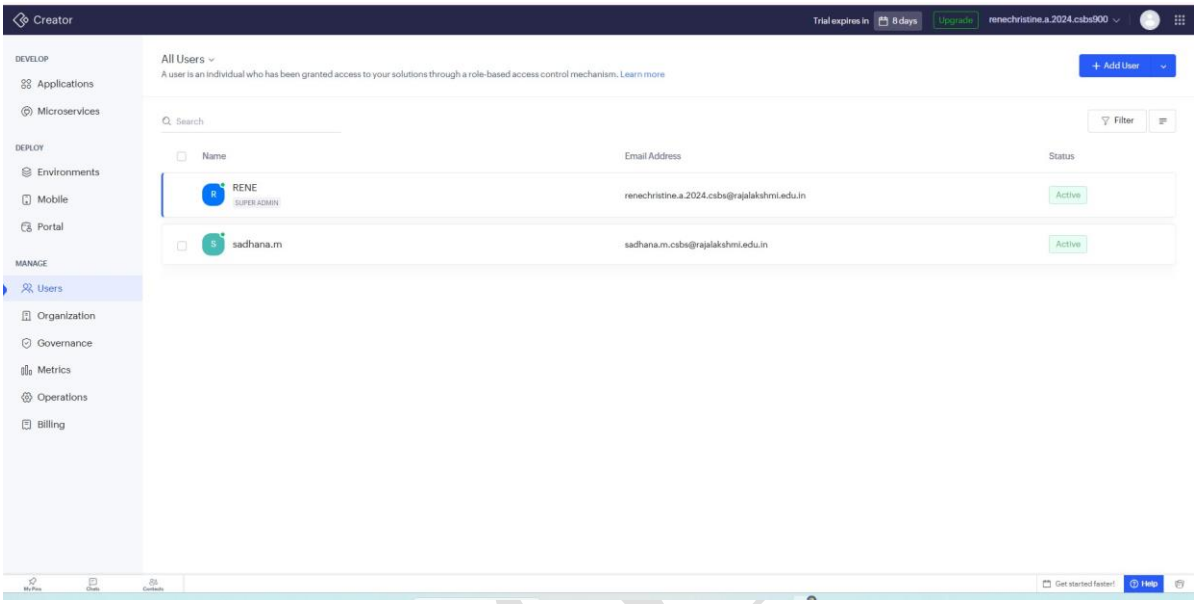


Fig 3: All Users page in Zoho Creator showing the users added to the application

Explanation: The All Users page confirms that the newly added user (samyuktha) appears alongside the Super Admin account (SHRI), and that every listed user has the status Active. This shows the role and permission assignment was saved successfully and that the user can now sign in and work in the application within the access granted to their role.

4. RESULT

Role-based access control was successfully configured for the "Student Admission Enquiry Form" application in Zoho Creator. Distinct roles and permission profiles were created for each category of user, a reporting hierarchy was established for the Admission Manager role with peer data sharing, portal users were restricted to add and view permission, and the application interface was localized to the user's browser language. This ensures every user interacts only with the data and features appropriate to their role, while workflow automations continue to run correctly underneath the configured access layer. A user was also added to the application with the Admission Staff role and listed as Active.